



AFTER

The war began at Fort Sumter in Charleston harbor, when Confederate forces fired on the Union resupply vessel, galvanizing public opinion in both sections.

FORT SUMTER SURRENDERED

The secession crisis finally found a violent resolution at [Fort Sumter](#). The fort was surrendered to the Confederacy on April 13 after a day of bombardment.

CONFEDERATE CONSOLIDATION



SEAL OF THE CONFEDERATE STATES OF AMERICA

The outbreak of war forced the states of the **upper South to make a decision**. Four of them—Arkansas, North Carolina, Tennessee, and Virginia—decided to cast their lot in with their slave-holding brethren.

PUBLIC OUTRAGE IN THE NORTH

The powerful symbolism of a successful Confederate attack on a U.S. military installation had a **transforming effect** on Northern public opinion, with the result that even most Northern Democrats were now **prepared to commit themselves to war**. Before the attack, staunchly radical Republicans had been among those happy to consider the idea of "letting them [the Confederate states] go," to use editor Horace Greeley's words in an editorial in the *New York Tribune*. The **assault on Fort Sumter** galvanized people's patriotism and inspired a **desire to avenge** the Confederacy's insult to the flag.